The Shadow and Astronomy

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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The Shadow and Astronomy

#1
03-14-2015, 02:20 PM

So I've been working on a timeline both for the real world and the World of Darkness. While I've been jumping around, I've mostly been focused on Paleolithic and Neolithic Meso/South America the last couple of days, but I've also been adding on bits and pieces that are relevant to the various lines as I go. For Werewolf, obviously one of those big events in the Apollo 11 Moon landing, along with the other Apollo Missions. It hit me though that Apollo wasn't the first time man had safely landed something on the Moon, that distinction goes to the USSR's Luna-9 Lander, which, along with Luna 13, and the USA's Surveyors 1, 3, 5, 6, and 7, landed on the Moon years before Apollo. It wouldn't be huge assumption to guess that they brought along with them or generated spirits of technology, exploration, science, and wonder, as well as possibly nationalism, capitalism, socialism, competitiveness, and pride. It get's me thinking, how would all of this effected the Moon-bound? Would they have noticed since there was no human presence? Would they have cared?

Working away through Werewolf 2e at the same time, I stumbled upon the story of Lul'aya, and how the False Father rode along with spirits of information from Apollo 11 back to earth. That made me question, if the information spirits could travel back to earth with information as their sole vessel, could the soft landers have enabled something similar? And what would the implications of the Chang'e 3 Lander touching down on the Moon be in that case, considering that it landed in December of 2013, making it the first new object on the Moon in nearly 40 years?

Finally, that also sparked this idea. If spirits can flow one way in the Shadow of space, couldn't they flow the other way too. And if they could, could werewolves follow? None of the Forsaken have contacted the spirits of the planets, but in an age where technology and information proliferate so quickly, is it only a matter of time? Is there a pack out there who's totem is the spirit of the Curiosity Rover, and has found a secret pathway between Earth and Mars? Are there wolves who seek even more esoteric spirits, like those of comets or black holes? If the internet is physical place in the Shadow (and I say it is) could anyone with a connection to the internet walk into the Shadow of the ISS via their live feed?

These are idle questions, and not for everyone, but I think it opens up a huge new can of worms that are very, very interesting.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

Tags: None

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Felipe
Member

Join Date: Oct 2014
Posts: 538

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03-14-2015, 02:34 PM #2

Apparently 2ed brings forth the notion that there are Spirits outside the Earth's Shadow, and that Luna and the Lunes are what keep them for invading it. Helios seen to be responsible for the opposite, his power is described as to keep the Earth's spirits in.

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nofather
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 11016

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03-14-2015, 03:06 PM #3

There's definitely spirits in outer space. The Shadow on Earth is vibrant, in its own way, because humans give a lot of essence, but a planet that's been uninhabited and unknown since its creation would still have a spirit and probably a whole range of lesser spirits of the planets features.

Part of the problem though is that werewolves, as is, can't really go there because they still follow the basic laws of physics in the Shadow and can't just fly off the Earth. They might be able to contact a spirit that could do it for them, but even then the logistics involved might stymie them, as it would likely be slower than a shuttle's trip and the werewolf would be spending a lot of time in the Hisil that would have an effect on them and would still need basic necessities like food. Apparently in the Hisil the 'space' part of space is empty spiritually. I think Luna keeps Earth off-limits to other planet spirits, and it might block access two ways.

That said while devices landing on the moon probably brought awareness of mankind to the idigam, if they didn't have it before, most trips to the moon were one way. Even landers weren't the only things to come onto the moon, as the idigam have been influenced by debris and meteors that may have crashed upon it.

Last edited by nofather; 03-14-2015, 03:12 PM.

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wyrdhamster
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Join Date: Dec 2013
Posts: 11313

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03-14-2015, 03:43 PM #4

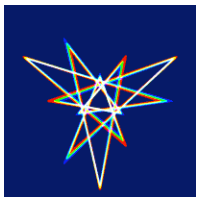
Originally posted by ***Second Chances***

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I always assumed that Space Race of 60s brought to Moon new Essence that was divided and ingested in Idigams for all the centuries of imprisonment. Think of it - you are locked in empty space for ages. Your food source (Essence) is nowhere to be found, as the surface of Moon does not generate it (or in very tiny doses). Then, with USSR and USA space race, on the surface of your prison lands some appetite small spirits, with new Essence, which you did not eaten in millenia. I assume that Idigam leached on them, fight for them, and ate them quickly - and then waited for proper Moon landing with humans, to have a way back n Earth, finally.

Last edited by wyrdhamster; 03-14-2015, 03:46 PM.

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branford
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Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 1904

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03-14-2015, 04:06 PM #5

Mage 1e certainly indicates that there are significant and unusual spirit courts on the other planets in the solar system (or at least the seven "classic" planets). Most of this info can be found in the entry for the Thrice-Great in Legacies: The Ancient, p. 110-20.

However, whether these non-terrestrial planetary spirit courts will still exist in Mage 2e or should be included in WtF 2e, is a question best left to the relevant developers or the discretion of your GM and gaming group.

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Acrozatarim
Member

Join Date: Dec 2013
Posts: 1892

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03-16-2015, 09:42 AM #6

The Warden Moon's orbit marks a boundary against the extraterrestial Shadow; the ability of some idigam to call down void spirits gives some hints as to the least of what may be out there in the starlight expanse of space.

- Chris Allen, Aberrant Line Developer, Freelance Writer

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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03-21-2015, 06:16 AM #7

> *Originally posted by **Acrozatarim***
> *The Warden Moon's orbit marks a boundary against the extraterrestial Shadow; the ability of some idigam to call down void spirits gives some hints as to the least of what may be out there in the starlight expanse of space.*

A Boundary, yes, but even the fact that idigam can call Void Spirits show that that boundary is far from absolute. Heck, we even see that with the presence of Hellions and one supernova spirit that may or may not be running around the planet.

Speaking of the boundary though, that reminds me of The Pure's explanation of the idigam begin powerful spirits unleashed when Apollo 11 violated the boundaries of where humans were allowed to exist. Even if we take that as The Pure's own propaganda, couldn't the Moon missions and and our artificial satellites have weakened Luna's wards and start to allow the spirits of the

extraterrestial to at lease occasionally sneak into earth?

Ultimately, I know everything that I'm proposing here is at best in a very "Storyteller's prerogative" type of territory, but I think there are some very interesting stories that could be told by incorporating extraterrestial Shadow, so I'd like to explore what types of spirits may be out there, and how we could bring them into stories.

> *Originally posted by* ***nofather***
>
> *There's definitely spirits in outer space. The Shadow on Earth is vibrant, in its own way, because humans give a lot of essence, but a planet that's been uninhabited and unknown since its creation would still have a spirit and probably a whole range of lesser spirits of the planets features.*
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I know that there is the specific example of Hellion's solar winds keeping spirits (werewolf or no) from escaping Earth's bounds, but couldn't a Space-That-Isn't act as a bridge between the earth and another celestial body? If the Space-That-Isn't represents a data stream, or quick communication, that could take care of the massive distance between say, Earth's Shadow and the ISS' Shadow. I'm not saying these would be common, but they could be useable to tell a particular story.

I also tend to think that while Hisil in space would actually be more analogous to humans in a desert... it looks very harsh, barren and lifeless until you realize that its really a matter of perspective. In space, things endure much longer, so they should be able to provide a constant supply of Essence for the spirits that feed off of them. It may not be the massive cornucopia that life on earth generates, but its still there, just different from what werewolves expect.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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03-24-2015, 07:41 AM #8



Warpwind
Member

Join Date: Nov 2014
Posts: 608

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> *Originally posted by* ***branford***
> *Mage 1e certainly indicates that there are significant and unusual spirit courts on the other planets in the solar system (or at least the seven "classic" planets). Most of this info can be found in the entry for the Thrice-Great in Legacies: The Ancient, p. 110-20.*
>
> *However, whether these non-terrestrial planetary spirit courts will still exist in Mage 2e or should be included in WtF 2e, is a question best left to the relevant developers or the discretion of your GM and gaming group.*

a very sensible answer.

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